

Nose OUT OF JOINT

The quest for the perfect nose has become urban India's latest obsession in the pursuit of happiness and success

By Damayanti Datta

On his 14th birthday, he asked for a rhinoplasty. "What's that?" his parents asked. "Surgery to make my nose look better," he said. "No," declared his father. "I had a big nose as a child. It doesn't look so

bad now," consoled his mother. But as his friends continued to poke fun at him, he started spending hours in front of the mirror and browsing "nose communities" on the Net. He learnt from make-up sites how to hide a bulbous nose with blusher; bought "nose correctors" off dodgy sites; discussed liquid latex prosthesis on

theatre chat sites; tried putting spirit gum inside his nostrils for a pointy tip as suggested by "lost cause" groups. By the time he went to cosmetic surgeon Anup Dhir of Apollo Indraprastha, Delhi, he had tried it all and failed. He is just another among a multitude of nose-job wannabes who doctors come across every day.